

Table tops, bases and joints

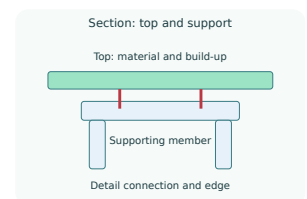
A table is a system of top, base and connections. Trace load paths, coordinate material interfaces and identify the evidence needed to review stability and performance.

What you will accomplish

- Define the top and support relationship
- Trace loads and compare bases
- Review connections, movement and disassembly

Define the top and support relationship

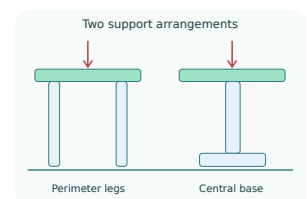
Record the top material, build-up, grain direction where relevant, edges, use and cleaning needs. A fixing detail cannot simply transfer between solid timber, faced board and stone. A section should identify top, support, connection and unsupported projection. An apparent thick edge may be an applied detail; appearance does not establish structural thickness.



Identify the actual build-up before selecting the interface.

Trace loads and compare bases

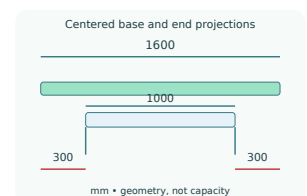
Trace load from top through frame or pedestal to floor contacts. A central base changes edge projections, while perimeter legs affect seating. A load-path sketch is not proof of adequacy. Define expected loading, edge use, sway, twisting and floor conditions for an appropriate technical review; do not improvise testing by standing on the table or adding arbitrary loads.



The load path defines the review; it does not certify capacity.

Review connections, movement and disassembly

Identify permanent/removable connections, tool access and material movement the system must accommodate. Solid timber dimensions can change with humidity; do not assume rigid restraint in every direction. Obtain a suitable manufacturer/specialist detail. In an exercise with a 1600 mm top and centered 1000 mm base length, each end projects $(1600 - 1000) \div 2 = 300$ mm; this does not validate the projection structurally.



300 mm is geometric projection, not a capacity approval.

Worked case and decision

The solid-timber top on a metal base has a 300 mm exercise projection at each end, but the drawing specifies rigid attachment without explaining movement accommodation. Return the interface for review and require the connection, movement and tool-access detail before manufacture.

Decision: complete the movement/connection detail and performance review.

Check understanding

What does the 300 mm projection calculation establish?

- Geometry only, not capacity
- Suitability of any material
- Connections are unnecessary

Correct: Geometry only, not capacity. Performance requires review of the complete system.

Lesson questions

Is the apparent edge thickness enough to choose a connection?

No. It may be an applied edge; obtain the actual section, material and build-up.

Practice

Submit a top/base section, load path, connection/disassembly detail, projection calculation and verification requirements.

Material and section

Load path and projection

Connection and verification

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- Actual build-up identified
- 300 mm under the assumption
- Geometry separated from performance